

词汇: shower 淋浴

- 1 This is a city like no other. An invisible army of **microbes** live here, including bacteria, fungi, moulds and **mites**, and it's the one place you'd have hoped would be clean – your **showerhead**.
- 2 If you **unscrew** it and take a peek inside, you might be surprised as to what you find – quite possibly a **slimy** dark **biofilm**. When you switch on the shower, it's not just steam and water that come out, but a **blast** of microbes as well. Rob Dunn, an evolutionary biologist from North Carolina State University, calls showerheads **extreme environments** because they are either **bone-dry** or soaking wet. Once you've showered, the head remains warm and **dries out** undisturbed, creating the perfect ecosystem for bacteria to feed on dissolved nutrients from the water.
- 3 It seems the majority of us don't need to worry about **catching a bug** from having a shower though. "Only showers contaminated with **Legionella** and other **opportunistic pathogens** pose a risk," says Frederik Hammes, a **drinking water** microbiologist at the Swiss Federal Institute of Aquatic Science and Technology in Switzerland. Meanwhile, one study in the US found that warmer areas, like Florida and Hawaii, with higher **chlorine** levels tend to have more pathogenic mycobacteria, which can lead to higher rates of a chronic lung infection called non-tuberculous mycobacteria (NTM) lung disease. This is likely because the showerhead has less time to dry out in more **tropical climates**, so bacteria can grow more easily.
- 4 Even if becoming ill from your showerhead is highly unlikely, you'd probably still like to reduce the number of bacteria coming out when you're trying to get clean. One study found that the **spray pattern** of your shower makes a difference – **mist** mode spreads NTM cells a lot more than a massage or rain showerhead, for example. Higher temperatures have also been shown to spread microbes more easily. The best way to keep bacteria away though is to regularly clean your showerhead by **descaling** it or soaking it in lemon juice.
- 5 Since we can't fully eradicate the microbes in our showers, and we like to stay clean, we'll have to learn to coexist with them.

测验与练习

一、为本文选择总结句。

1. Which statement best summarises the article?

- a. Showerhead microbes generally originate from human skin cells rather than the water supply.
- b. The likelihood of catching a disease is higher if you live in a cool climate.
- c. Microbes in your shower head are generally safe for most people.

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. Why is it easy for microbes to build up in a showerhead?

- a. Because microbes thrive in damp undisturbed environments.
- b. Because hot water encourages bacteria to multiply.
- c. Because dissolved nutrients can't leave the showerhead.

2. Showers contaminated with Legionella can be deadly.

- a. True
- b. False
- c. Not given

3. Pathogenic mycobacteria is most likely to be found in...

- a. a cool environment with high-chlorine levels in the water.
- b. a warm environment with high-chlorine levels in the water.
- c. a warm environment with low-chlorine levels in the water.

4. Which spray pattern is the worst for spreading NTM cells?

- a. mist
- b. massage
- c. rain

5. What does 'it' refer to in the following sentence? *The best way to keep bacteria away though is to regularly clean your showerhead by descaling it...*

- a. bacteria
- b. your shower
- c. your showerhead

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Look inside your showerhead and you might see a **1)** _____ film that's full of bacteria. These are the perfect **2)** _____ for **3)** _____. But you're unlikely to catch a bug unless your showerhead is **4)** _____ with Legionella or another dangerous **5)** _____.

contaminated	mist	microbes
pathogen		dry out
environment		slimy

（答案见词汇表后）

词汇表

microbe	微生物
mite	螨虫
showerhead	淋浴头
unscrew	拧开
slimy	黏黏糊糊的
biofilm	生物膜
blast	一大股
extreme environment	极端环境
bone-dry	完全干燥的
dry out	逐渐干燥
catch a bug	生病
Legionella	军团菌
opportunistic	投机的
pathogen	病原体
drinking water	饮用水
chlorine	氯
tropical climate	热带气候
spray pattern	喷流模式
mist	雾
descale	去除水垢

答案

一、为本文选择总结句。

c. Microbes in your shower head are generally safe for most people.

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **a.** *Once you've showered, the **head remains warm and dries out undisturbed, creating the perfect ecosystem for bacteria** to feed on dissolved nutrients from the water.*

2. **c. Not given.** *"Only showers contaminated with **Legionella** and other opportunistic pathogens **pose a risk**,"... 'Deadly' is not mentioned, only a 'risk'.*

3. **b.** *Meanwhile, one study in the US found that **warmer** areas, like Florida and Hawaii, with **higher chlorine levels tend to have more pathogenic mycobacteria**...*

4. **a.** *...**mist mode spreads NTM cells a lot more than a massage or rain showerhead**...*

5. **c.** *The best way to keep bacteria away though is to regularly **clean your showerhead by descaling it**...*

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Look inside your showerhead and you might see a **slimy** film that's full of bacteria. These are the perfect **environment** for **microbes**. But you're unlikely to catch a bug unless your showerhead is **contaminated** with Legionella or another dangerous **pathogen**.